

SYDNEY POLLOCK

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I am a data and Machine Learning enthusiast, fascinated by how real-world impact data insights can revolutionise business decisions. I bring 3 years of professional experience translating BI dashboards to clients, turning abstract data points into actionable recommendations for stakeholders, and a drive to use my technical skills to create these insights myself.

✓ Python	✓ NumPy	✓ Hugging Face
✓ Pandas	✓ Matplotlib	✓ LLMs
✓ Scikit-learn	✓ Seaborn	✓ Deep Learning Frameworks
✓ NLTK	✓ Regex	✓ Exposure to Azure
✓ SpaCy	✓ Foundational SQL	✓ Prompt Engineering
✓ PyTorch	✓ Feature Selection	✓ Machine Learning algorithms
	✓ No-code AI Agents	

Education

MSc Natural Language Processing - Cardiff University (2024-2025)

Taught Stage completed with Distinction, Dissertation Stage completed, awaiting final grade.

Projects include:

- **Data Science programming tasks** (Regression analysis and prediction, logistic regression and random forest algorithms, feature selection, data exploration, manipulation and visualisation, statistical analysis)
- **Optimisation and evaluation of neural network model** (BERT) for hate speech classification, working with real-world data
- Argument Mining and GenAI feedback as an educational tool (**Data pre-processing** for input into a pipeline of prompt-engineered LLMs - Llama and Gemma, and **post-processing** for analysis)
- **Fine-tuning neural network** model (ELECTRA) for identifying chapter boundaries in non-linear novels

Modules:

- Machine Learning and Advanced Topics in NLP
- Computational Data Science
- Computational Linguistics
- Human Centric Computing

Independent Self-Study

- **Azure AI Fundamentals Certification**
 - o AI, ML, Computer Vision, NLP and GenAI workloads on Azure
- **Azure Fundamentals Certification**
 - o Cloud concepts, Azure architecture, services, management and governance
- **Azure Data Fundamentals Certification**
 - o Core data concepts, relational / non-relational data, analytics workloads on Azure

- **Microsoft Power Platform Certification**
 - o Business value and management of the Power Platform environment, Power Apps, Power Automate, Power Pages
- Learning SQL and Big Query with an eagerness to advance this and other programming languages
- Using synthetic Kaggle data to build a **Tableau** dashboard, visualising homelessness and shelter demand across cities in the USA
- Attended Dust x Paatch – ‘Build an AI Agent in an Hour’ Workshop and Buildathon

BA (Hons) English and Linguistics. 2:1 - University of York (2018-2021)

- Investigation of linguistic syntactic structure, of which I highly enjoyed constructing syntax trees, and honing my analytical and logical mindset
- Analysis of acoustic waveforms and spectrograms
- Neurolinguistics and neurocognition for language production and processing

Bournemouth School for Girls (2011-2018)

- A-levels: English Literature (A*), Psychology (A*), English Language (A)
- AS-levels: Information and Communication Technology (A), Biology (B)
- 11 GCSEs (A*-C) incl. Maths (A*), Further Maths and English

Employment

Explore Learning

Centre Director (June 2022 – July 2024)

- Data analysis to identify retention risks, implemented proactive solutions to hit KPIs
- Presented honest, data-driven insights to diverse stakeholders, adapting communication style for different audiences (parents, management, regional peers)
- Managed a hybrid team of 20+ tutors, 250 clients, and collaborated with colleagues nationwide.

Assistant Director (September 2021 - June 2022)

Tutor (September 2016 - September 2021) and (July 2024 – present)

Volunteering

Muddy Boots Nursery (January – March 2020)

- Speech and language placement, carrying out assessments and intervention tasks

Second/Third Year Mentor – University of York (October 2019 – June 2020)

- Holding household meetings to provide guidance to first year university students

Halifax College Wellbeing Officer – University of York (January – December 2020)

- Organising and running wellbeing events for University of York students

Other activities

- Attended Cardiff University’s 4th NLP Workshop
- Completion of Bronze, Silver and Gold Duke of Edinburgh Awards
- Always having a jigsaw puzzle on the go and a sudoku book in my handbag